



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: North Hills Christian School
School Website: <https://www.northhillschristian.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

North Hills Christian School (NHCS) presents a consciously Christ-centered, biblically oriented program that emphasizes formation of heart, mind, and spirit within a framework of Biblical truth. Public materials repeatedly describe NHCS as Christ-centered, biblically grounded, and formation-focused, with an overarching mission to equip hearts and minds to impact the world for Christ. There is explicit articulation of a transcendent moral framework (truth, goodness, beauty) and theology integrated into school life, worship, and daily practice. The school also foregrounds a holistic, family-oriented community with ongoing spiritual life, chapel, service opportunities, and partnerships with parents. However, while NHCS uses contemporary, college-preparatory language and reports strong academic outcomes, explicit references to a classical curriculum (e.g., Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Socratic seminars) are less prominent in public materials, though the school proudly characterizes its approach as "classically influenced" in some content.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale in brief: - Strong religious/metaphysical foundations and a clear mission rooted in truth and Christ-centered formation (Classical in substance for Element 1). - Purpose/goal framed as formation and virtue with a Biblical telos, but with contemporary college-prep language that injects some non-classical elements (Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). - Curriculum described as classically influenced rather than explicitly Trivium/Quadrivium with Great Books; NHCS's own language emphasizes classical influence but not a full Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum as commonly defined in classical education (Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). - Pedagogy includes restful/spiritual/theological elements and collaborative, inquiry-oriented practices, but lacking a consistently explicit Socratic/seminar-centric high-school pedagogy across the board (Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). - Faculty portrayals emphasize leadership, mission-driven staff, and mentoring within a Christian framework, but the public materials do not consistently present the "living curriculum" portrait or fully articulated classical faculty culture (Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). - Parents and community partnerships are robust and foundational; strong parent involvement is emphasized, with open-campus and co-educator language (Element 6: CLASSICAL).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: NHCS presents a biblically grounded, Christ-centered mission; statements of faith; weekly chapel, Bible study, worship, and service; a Trinity-like emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty in the foundational material; theology integrated into daily life; spiritual life is described as essential to formation of the whole person. See Mission/Vision/Values statements and Spiritual Life materials.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Present terms include truth, Christ, biblical worldview, worship, chapel, prayer, service, Sacred, theology, sacred scripture, and covenant language. Negatives (secular neutrality, relativism) are not evidenced in public materials. The lexicon of classical indicators identifies truth, theology, liturgy, worship, sacred music, and reverence as positive signals; NHCS shows multiple of these signals in practice. Positive keyword hits are frequent; negative indicators appear absent in public messaging. Overall, category leans CLASSICAL.

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- Why this rating: Demonstrated transcendental/moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty) and a grounded theology; liturgical/communal practices; a clear, Christ-centered spiritual formation framework. The absence of secular or value-neutral language in core public messaging reinforces CLASSICAL alignment. See evidence sources cited above.
 - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Mission emphasizes formation (“equip hearts and minds to impact the world for Christ”) and a telos oriented toward virtue and wisdom within a Biblical framework; Vision highlights truth, character, service; references to formation over information (formation-oriented language) appear in mission/vision statements; NHCS is described as a “Christ-centered classically influenced education” in public content.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, character, and service. The site lacks explicit statements about secular, job-focused training as the primary aim; however, it also uses college-preparatory language and tangible outcomes (e.g., test data, college readiness) that signal work/college orientation in practice. Positive keyword density around formation and teleology is high; negative signals (e.g., “workforce prep” without classical framing) are not evident in core messaging. Overall, more formation/teleology present than job-focused framing, but not exclusively non-work-oriented.
 - Why this rating: The school emphasizes formation and virtue as ends of education, with a strong teleological frame; but the presence of college-prep language and measurable outcomes alongside formation language places it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLEARLY CLASSICAL across the board. See mission/vision statements and strategic content.
 - Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: NHCS describes itself as “Christ-centered classically influenced education” with a long-standing mission and strategic plan; it features honors tracks and an AIM/Victors program for individualization in K–12. The site mentions a classical influence but does not consistently advertise the full Liberal Arts tria (grammar/logic/rhetoric) or the Great Books program; the content does not foreground explicit Great Books study or the Trivium/Quadrivium as core curricular architecture. See History and Strategic Plan references and the “classically influenced” phrasing.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include “classically influenced,” “great conversation” (though not necessarily explicit Great Books), or references to the liberal arts in a classical frame. The lack of explicit Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium and the emphasis on mission/values suggest partial alignment. Negative keywords from the lexicon (e.g., “STEM-first framing,” “project-based learning dominance”) do not appear as primary curricular framing; however, the absence of explicit Great Books or Trivium cues reduces the strength of classical curricular alignment. Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating: Content signals a classical orientation in spirit and branding, but public curriculum articulation stops short of a full, traditional classical curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Trivium/Quadrivium) in the visible materials. See phrasing “classically influenced” and related content.
 - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: NHCS emphasizes contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) through its spiritual life integration and a structured, inquiry-oriented approach evidenced by PLCs, collaborative teaching, and Honors options; however, explicit e.g., Socratic seminars, classical narration, or chant-based memory work are not consistently described in public-facing materials. A recent post discusses collaborative teaching and innovative instructional platforms; lower-school practices (singing, memory work) are not widely documented in public material, though the Six Elements lexicon suggests these are classical signals. See “North Hills Embraces Innovative Academics with Tailored Support and Collaborative Teaching” (teacher collaboration, PLCs, Honors, AIM) and the Spiritual Life components.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Socratic dialogue/seminar (not explicitly claimed), scholé/restful learning, chant/memory in some classical models, and seminar-
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style inquiry in high school. NHCS shows memory-friendly elements and collaborative teaching but does not consistently advertise classic Socratic seminars or rigorous dialectic in high school as a primary method. Negative signals (project-based-only or constructivist emphasis) are not explicit as primary thrusts. Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Why this rating: The presence of restful, formation-oriented pedagogy and collaborative teaching signals aligns with classical ideals, but the lack of explicit, consistent Socratic/seminar pedagogy and a clear Trivium-based method across all grades places NHCS in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. See PLCs, Honors/AIM, and Spiritual Life content.
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: NHCS describes its leadership and faculty as knowledgeable and mission-driven; public materials present a framework in which teachers are engaged, mentored, and aligned with the school's mission; there are statements about student-teacher mentorship and a living-education approach (the school's philosophy and six-goal framework guide decisions). The site lists administrators and educators across lower/middle/upper schools, with a focus on character formation and professional development (AIM, PLCs, coaching). See Administration and Faculty sections and the Strategic Plan language.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include “model teachers,” “mentors,” “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” and “faculty as core.” NHCS publicly emphasizes mentorship, servant leadership, and the spiritual life director's leadership, which map to key classical signals. However, explicit language about a uniform “portraits of teacher” or a formal “faculty living curriculum” is less explicit in public materials. The presence of strong leadership emphasizing formation suggests SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL due to less explicit articulation of the traditional “living curriculum” portrait. See Administration content and mission statements.
 - Why this rating: The school presents a strong, virtue-informed faculty culture and mentorship, yet the public materials do not consistently present the full “living curriculum” portrait or the tight classical-faculty culture some classical schools articulate. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: NHCS emphasizes partnerships with families, parental involvement, and open campus access as a core feature; admissions policies frame parental alignment with the mission/statement of faith, and NHCS invites parent engagement through book studies, gatherings, and community activities; the “Mission, Vision, Values” page foregrounds a partnership with families and a family-centered environment; the site notes parent involvement, tours, and opportunities to engage in the school's religious and civic life. See Mission/Vision/Values content and Admissions Policy.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include partnership with families, parental formation, open campus, family-centered culture, and parental involvement as co-teachers. The lexicon for “Parents and Community” emphasizes parent partnership and home-school synergy; NHCS messaging aligns with these. Negative keywords (e.g., “consumer” parent behavior) are not present. The presence of explicit parent-partnership language and community events is a strong classical signal.
 - Why this rating: NHCS actively positions parents as co-educators and welcomes ongoing parent engagement; “Partnership with Families” and “Parent Formation” signals are clear, aligning with classical expectations for family-school partnership. This category is CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment - Overall ranking across the six categories: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Rationale: NHCS shows strong religious/metaphysical foundations (Element 1: CLASSICAL) and robust parent/community partnership (Element 6: CLASSICAL). However, curriculum and pedagogy assertion lean toward “classically influenced” rather than full classical practice (Categories 3 and 4), and faculty portrayal and school purpose lean toward formation-with-contemporary-education language (Categories 2, 5). The aggregate balance places NHCS in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear needle-mover potential in articulating a fuller classical curriculum (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium), more explicit Socratic pedagogy in upper grades, and a stronger “living curriculum” faculty portrait that is publicly stated.

What Would Move the Needle - Make Classical Curriculum explicit and public: clearly articulate Trivium/Quadrivium elements, Great Books/primary-sources program, and a formal Great Conversation approach across relevant grades. - Elevate Socratic pedagogy in upper grades: implement and publicize a structured, ongoing Socratic seminar/dialectic framework, with rubrics and exemplars, across upper-school courses. - Strengthen “Living Curriculum” language for Faculty: publish a formal portrait of the teacher as mentor and living curriculum, with explicit professional-development pathways rooted in classical pedagogy. - Deepen liturgical integration with curricular coherence: align liturgical calendar, chapel themes, and reflection across disciplines with a stronger integrative pedagogy, including contemplative inquiry and aesthetic formation. - Expand Great Books and primary-source study within core history and literature courses, with cross-disciplinary connections to philosophy and theology to reinforce the Great Conversation approach.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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